

sals: protection and sanctuary against outside threats. Whatever their house, court, or personal proclivities, almost all changelings abide by the set of basic fae laws known as the Escheat.

The Escheat

The traditions called the Escheat are the basic laws of Kithain society. They were recorded after the Sundering as a means of preserving and protecting fae, helping them survive the changes all around them. They have been passed down and enforced by the nobility. Both the Seelie and Unseelie Courts respect the tenets that comprise the Escheat, though each court tends to have variations on their interpretation of each principle. While Seelie tend to follow the letter of the law, the Unseelie most often find loopholes to slip through.

Unlike oaths, the Escheat is not enforced by Glamour, but by tradition and custom. Occasionally, however, the Dreaming subtly steps in and works to enforce its rules, or weaves consequences for those who break its tenets too egregiously.

The six basic rights of the Escheat are:

- ⑤ **The Right of Demesne** — A lord is the king of his domain; he is judge and jury over all crimes, rendering judgment for all under his purview. A noble expects obedience from his vassals and respect from all others. In return, the noble respects those superior to him.

Reality: Whether they like it or not, the nobility has had to concede that modern ideas of democracy and popular rule are realities now. Still, most nobles rule through force, cunning, personal magnetism, and custom.

- ⑤ **The Right to Dream** — Mortals have a right to dream unhindered by fae needs. The Dreaming will die if we steal directly from the font. No one is allowed to use Glamour to manipulate the creative process. We may inspire creativity, but it is forbidden to give direct instructions or infuse a human with raw Glamour.

Reality: Most changelings see this as a prohibition against Ravaging. Many, particularly Unseelie, ignore this and seek a quick fix or a way to more power. Since this tends to permanently drain the mortal of Glamour, convicted Ravagers suffer harsh penalties. Rhapsody (p. 263) is much more clearly a violation of this tenet... but it happens.

- ⑤ **The Right of Ignorance** — Changelings are forbidden to betray the Dreaming to Banality. They must never reveal their true natures to humanity. Not only will humankind hunt fae down for our power and wisdom, it will overwhelm us and try to destroy our places of power. The more humanity knows, the more they will seek us, draining our souls of Glamour and trapping us in a petrifying morass of Banality.

Reality: Most changelings, whether Seelie or Unseelie, obey this as it provides protection against Banality. Glamour is difficult to find, and expending it on mortals so they can witness the Dreaming is wasteful. That said, bringing mortals into freeholds as retainers or lovers, but disenchanting them to erase knowledge of fae existence when they are sent home, is a long and glorious tradition.

- ⑤ **The Right of Rescue** — All Kithain have the right to be rescued from Banality. All changelings are in danger from this threat and none can be left behind. All Kithain are required to rescue other faeries or creatures of the Dreaming trapped by those who serve Banality.

Reality: Most changelings adhere to this as they might need rescuing themselves one day. Seelie and Unseelie forget their differences and extend aid to any Kithain when one is in the hands of the Autumn People or another agent of Banality. While many fae try to rescue griffins or unicorns and other powerful creatures of the Dreaming, most don't risk themselves for minor chimera.

- ⑤ **The Right of Safe Haven** — All places of the Dreaming are sacred. Changelings cannot allow those places to be endangered. All who seek refuge in those places must be admitted, Freeholds must be kept free of worldly violence and Banality.

Reality: Competition for the few freeholds to survive the Shattering make this law difficult to administer. Rival claims for the same area may lead to warfare, though combat on the actual grounds is usually restricted to chimeric combat. Some lords also bar their freeholds to outsiders, fearing they will drain the Glamour of the location needed to keep a supply for its residents. Despite the traditions of hospitality and courtesy, many nobles find that the demands are too heavy on them. Commoner freeholds are more likely to admit those seeking refuge.

- ⑤ **The Right of Life** — No Kithain may spill the lifeblood of another Kithain. No Kithain has the right to take one of its own from the Dreaming. Death is anathema.

Reality: This law is almost universally upheld. The Dreaming itself enforces it by inflicting Banality on any changeling that takes another changeling's life. When two changelings battle or duel, they usually wield chimerical weapons which don't deal "real" wounds. If the loser is "killed," he doesn't really die. He simply slips away from the Dreaming until reawakened by an infusion of Glamour. Some battles are fought to first blood. Anything more than this requires the permission of a king or queen since the death of any Kithain is a wound on the Dreaming itself. That said, changelings murder each other unofficially just as frequently as mortals do.

Kingdom of Concordia

The Kingdom of Concordia comprises all of the North American continent. Taking its name from the great dream that the changelings of the Interregnum and the returning sidhe could learn to coexist in a world of reawakened dreams, Concordia consists of eight kingdoms (and two territories of questionable allegiances) ruled over by a High King. Formed out of the shattered pieces left by the Accordance War, Concordia tries to combine the best of the medieval paradigm so familiar to the changelings of old with the new dreams forged during the long years between the Shattering and the Return. The quality of its success changes from day to day.

The political boundaries and freeholds described below can serve as a Storyteller's aid to provide physical structure to the